The AI Interview Protocol

How Vista Growth can turn its $7,500 audit into a self-service qualification engine — and why Jackie can build it in 8 weeks

Juergen Berkessel

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THE PROBLEM

Scaling Your Best Product

The AI Transformation Audit is Vista Growth's entry product — $7,500, delivered over 2 weeks. Current state assessment, AI Opportunity Matrix, ROI projections, 90-day action plan.

It's good work. But it requires Steve or Jackie in a room for every engagement. That's a bottleneck, not a business.

What if prospects could experience a taste of the audit before they buy — and Vista Growth got qualified leads while they sleep?

CURRENT MODEL

- Manual discovery calls
- 1 client at a time
- No pre-qualification
- Prospects learn nothing until they pay

THE OPPORTUNITY

AI Interviews Outperform Everything

Conversational AI interviews are a new category. Not chatbots. Not forms. Not surveys. They're **adaptive, voice-based conversations** that probe, follow up, and summarize — and the data on them is striking.

95%
COMPLETION
Audio AI interviews

10-30%
COMPLETION
Traditional web forms

5x
RICHER DATA
With AI probing follow-ups

78%
PREFER AI
Over human interviewers

Anthropic's own study: 1,250 AI interviews — **97.6% satisfaction**, 99% would recommend. Participants valued the AI's ability to summarize and reflect back what they said.

WHY AUDIO

Skip Video. Go Voice-Only.

The research is clear: audio-only beats video on every metric that matters. No camera anxiety, no lighting hassles, no avatar uncanny valley. Just a conversation.

People are more honest when they're not being watched. No micro-reactions trigger response filtering. No demographic matching concerns. The absence of visual judgment signals is the feature.

95% COMPLETION | VIDEO: 40-60% | 10-20X CHEAPER

WHAT MAKES AI INTERVIEWS WORK

- AI summarizes and reflects back
- Adaptive follow-ups based on answers
- Transparent about AI nature (builds trust)
- No judgment signals — greater candor
- Pause, reflect, resume on own schedule

THE PRODUCT

The Vista Growth AI Readiness Interview

A 15-minute audio conversation at **audit.vistagrowth.ai**. The prospect talks. The AI listens, probes, and scores. Vista Growth gets a qualified lead with structured data before anyone picks up the phone.

WHAT THE PROSPECT GETS

15-min adaptive conversation covering their marketing ops, tech stack, team size, AI usage, and pain points

AI-scored ***"transformation readiness"*** across multiple dimensions

Personalized PDF report with Vista Growth branding

Clear CTA to book the full $7,500 engagement

WHAT VISTA GROWTH GETS

Full transcript + AI-generated summary in Airtable

Qualification score — **know who's worth a call** before calling

Structured data on pain points, budget signals, urgency

Prospects pre-sold on Vista Growth's expertise through the experience itself

The interview IS the sales tool. Prospects experience firsthand what **well-designed AI interaction** feels like — which is exactly what Vista Growth promises to deliver.

ARCHITECTURE

How It Works

Prospect Arrives
audit.vistagrowth.ai

›

AI Interview
15 min, adaptive

›

Score + Report
PDF emailed to prospect

›

Airtable CRM
Transcript + scores

›

Steve Calls
Pre-qualified lead

COST PER INTERVIEW

$2-5 per 15-minute interview using voice AI APIs like Retell.ai or Vapi.ai (varies by LLM and voice quality). At 50 interviews/month, that's **$100-250** — less than one hour of consulting time.

CONVERSION MATH

50 interviews → 47 complete (95% rate) → ~10 qualified leads → 2-3 close at $7,500 = **$15,000-22,500** from ~$250 in AI costs.

BEYOND QUALIFICATION

Three Strategic Plays

The interview protocol isn't just a lead gen tool. It's a platform that opens three distinct revenue and credibility strategies for Vista Growth.

01

Lead Qualification — Light Version

A short, open interview for new prospects. They self-qualify, get a free report, and **experience AI-powered consulting firsthand**. This is the entry point — the door opener.

› Evolves into deeper post-signup interviews

02

Multi-Stakeholder Deep Dive

Post-signup, multiple people from the same org take **role-specific interviews** — CMO gets strategy questions, ops gets workflow questions. The system generates an organizational rollup — where leaders agree, where they diverge. That divergence is a consultable finding itself.

03

White-Label for Clients

Once the protocol works for Vista Growth, **license the framework to clients.** Their own branded AI interviews for customer research, employee surveys, market assessments. New revenue stream from the same architecture.

PLATFORM OPTIONS

Buy a Platform or Build Your Own

Two real options. Each has trade-offs.

BUY — Use an Existing Platform

Platforms like **TheySaid** ($49-149/mo, free tier) or **Ribbon AI** ($499-999/mo) offer conversational AI interviews out of the box — adaptive questioning, built-in analysis, reporting.

- Fast to launch — days, not weeks
- Good for validating the concept
- Limited branding and customization
- No multi-stakeholder rollups

$49-999/MO | DAYS TO LAUNCH

BUILD — Jackie Builds It with Retell.ai

Same boilerplate as PolyWiz. **Retell.ai** or **Vapi.ai** handle the voice AI (~$2-5 per interview depending on configuration). Jackie builds the branded UI, scoring engine, PDF reports, and multi-stakeholder rollups.

- White-labeled at audit.vistagrowth.ai
- Full control — branding, scoring, rollups
- **Proves Vista Growth builds AI tools**
- 4-6 weeks development time

~$2-5/INTERVIEW | ~$150-300/MO

THE BUILD

8-Week Timeline

WEEKS 1-2 Design + Validate

Design the interview flow — 15-20 questions across marketing ops, tech stack, team structure, AI readiness

Deploy on TheySaid (free tier)

Run 10-20 test interviews with friendly contacts. Iterate on question flow and scoring.

WEEKS 3-4 Production + Integration

Move to Ribbon AI for real-time voice conversations

Connect to Airtable — transcripts, scores, lead qualification

Design the branded PDF report template. Set up email delivery with CTA.

WEEKS 5-6 Custom Build

Jackie clones the boilerplate, integrates Retell.ai voice API

White-labeled at audit.vistagrowth.ai — full brand control

Multi-stakeholder support: independent interviews per participant, organizational rollup view.

WEEKS 7-8 Launch + Optimize

Go live with real prospects. Monitor completion rates and qualification accuracy.

Tune scoring model based on which leads actually convert to audits

Begin pitching multi-stakeholder assessments as a premium upsell.

JACKIE'S BUILD

Same Boilerplate. Different Product.

The same Next.js + Supabase boilerplate that powered PolyWiz gives Jackie a running start. Authentication, database, dashboard, API routes — all solved. She focuses on the interview logic, the scoring model, and the report generation.

The voice AI is an API call. Retell.ai handles speech-to-text, the conversational AI, and the transcript. Jackie's app handles everything around it — the branded UI, the scoring, the PDF, the CRM flow.

NEXT.JS | SUPABASE | RETELL.AI | CLAUDE CODE

WHAT JACKIE BUILDS

- Landing page + interview embed
- Scoring engine (AI-scored dimensions)
- PDF report generator
- Admin dashboard for Steve
- Multi-stakeholder rollup view

The Interview Is the Product

Prospects don't read whitepapers. They don't sit through webinars. But they'll spend 15 minutes talking about their own problems — and walk away impressed that Vista Growth built the tool that listened.

TIMELINE	RUNNING COST	BREAK-EVEN
8 weeks to launch	~$150-300/mo	1 closed audit